Cover Letter — IEEE Transactions on Engineering Management

Date: November 2026

To: The Editor-in-Chief, IEEE Transactions on Engineering Management

Subject: Submission of an original research article — “Governing Human–AI Collaborative Project Workflows in Multi-Platform Digital Delivery: A Design Science Study of Auditable Handoffs and Idempotent Release Operations”

Dear Editor,

Please consider the enclosed manuscript, “Governing Human–AI Collaborative Project Workflows in Multi-Platform Digital Delivery: A Design Science Study of Auditable Handoffs and Idempotent Release Operations”, for publication in *IEEE Transactions on Engineering Management*.

Engineering managers who delegate delivery work to AI agents must decide who may authorize an irreversible step and on what evidence. Following Design Science Research and stage-gate control theory, this study formalizes four software-enforced governance layers for human–AI collaborative delivery and implements them in two open-source artifacts, Agentic Work Lab and PublishOps CrossCast. The study reads stage gates as commit protocols: admission control at the gate, content binding of approvals, at-most-once commitment, end-to-end verification, and human resolution of in-doubt outcomes.

This study evaluates the framework in a nine-day field deployment (26 October–3 November 2026) in one creator–engineering laboratory. A 69-record operational journal records one platform write and no replayed upload; when Douyin's programmatic read-back timed out after the single final submission, the receipt stayed UNKNOWN, nothing was re-submitted, and the owner confirmed the work by phone. In one instrumented Instagram publication, 92.32% of the 412.217 s publish command was the wait after Share. The evaluated release software (PublishOps CrossCast, commit 75b7abc) carries 2,737 offline test functions, and 30 video versions (2.21 GB) are archived with recorded SHA-256 digests.

For IEEE TEM readers, the contribution links technology-management theory on stage gates, configuration management and human–automation authority to an operational design whose behaviour can be checked, and it shows where human work moves when automation is made safe.

The study is a single-case design science evaluation. The manuscript states the assumptions under which automated re-submission cannot occur, reports every figure descriptively, keeps human-led and AI-assisted cohorts apart rather than comparing them causally, and publishes the data, code and a script that recomputes every reported figure.

The manuscript (11 tables, 5 figures, 3 algorithms, 50 references; 24 pages as a single-column PDF, 32 pages in the single-column LaTeX build) is accompanied by online supplementary material. It is original, has not been published previously, and is not under consideration elsewhere.

Sincerely,

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